

5.d) Survey Research method in Anthropology

Survey research refers to the method of data collection in which quantifiable and qualitative data is collected directly by researcher.

Survey Research method's Features:-

- ① Pre-made list of questions
- ② Answers are directly filled by researcher
- ③ Questions can be quantifiable (eg) Age of informant vs qualitative (eg) Has she/he ever experienced domestic violence.
- ④ No extra questions are asked
- (Eg.) → Census 2011 ⇒ Quantifiable data mostly
→ NFHS-5 ⇒ Also qualitative data like "It used mobile" etc.

Significance

- ① Helpful in policy making and action anthropology
- ② Comparative analysis performed.
- ③ More population covered $\Rightarrow$ as without ^{knowing} the language, the Informer is recorded by researcher through translation
- ④ Helpful in Longitudinal studies
(eg. Recent 'India Ageing Report' on same method.)

Issues

- ① Challenge of use quantifying social variable.
- ② Privacy and confidentiality of data collection.

Survey research method provides new avenues and with rise of digital AI Technology, ~~and it~~ it can be further simplified.